

Grading Policy

Grading Scale

Grading in this course aims to dismantle oppressive grading structures and empower students to fully engage with learning to learn instead of merely regurgitating information for a grade. I encourage you to take risks in this class, engage in the content in a way that is playful, joyful and meaningful for you and the community you engage within. While an anti-oppressive grading structure may be new and unfamiliar territory for you please know that I will prioritize effort, engagement, creativity, and collaboration. I commit to providing constructive and critical evaluations of your contributions and products. Assignments will have rubrics provided so you understand if you are or are not meeting the standards. You will always be provided an opportunity to revise work that does not fully meet the assignment requirements. Throughout the course, desired learning outcomes, attendance as well as engagement will be tracked and you will receive feedback on your contributions.

Every student begins as an A student in this class. You maintain the A throughout the semester by putting in the effort, engaging and demonstrating understandings in assignments, discussions and group work. You will receive a standard letter grade at the end of the semester based on your ability to uphold the grading contract. Each aspect of the course does have correlating points you maintain in relation to a total of 100 possible points that equates to the letter grade A. Please refer to the below breakdown for potential ways that your A could be impacted.

- Excessive absences (More than 1 class in Summer session)
- Missing more than 2 discussion board posts.
- Submitting any assignment after an agreed upon deadline.
- Missing any of the major course assignments.
- Declining to revise work that does not meet the defined expectations

Instructor Grading Commitment: All assignments will be graded within 1 week of submission

Grading Scheme:

A 100-94

A- 93-90

B+ 89-87

B 86-83

B- 82-80

C 79-70

E - Fail

Grade Appeal Policy: Upon receiving graded material, please take time to read my comments and the directions for the assignment. I will **always** provide the opportunity to revise work that does not meet the rubric requirements. If you are concerned about the grade you have earned, you are welcome to write a grade appeal and plan to discuss the matter. Grade appeals (with complete justification for concern) must be submitted to me in writing within one week of the return of the assignment. After the one-week period has passed, grade appeals will not be considered.

Weighted Assignments:

Course Engagement (40 points):

(In class participation (24 points), Peer feedback (4 points), Discussion Boards (12 points)) :

As a graduate level consolidated course expect to invest **9-12 hours x2** a week on course work and readings. I will aim to provide choice, variety and depth to cultivate understanding. When there are more than 50 pages in a week, I will provide choice in the content you select from the range. The expectation will be that you have invested the time in yourself and that investment will reflect in your discussion board contributions and in class engagement. **6 times** throughout the semester you will respond to a prompt in the discussion board regarding the readings. You will be assigned to a group for when to post. When posting, I am asking you to highlight 3 quotes, pose 2 questions and make 1 connection to practice. We will then reserve a portion of the class time to discuss recurring themes from the discussion board/readings further. There will be a number of peer feedback sessions assignments which are meant to drive the collective capabilities of the group via meaningful, progress oriented feedback. Guidelines will be provided.

Literacy Narratives (10 points):

This assignment invites students to explore their personal and community literacy experiences. The literacy narrative encourages students to reflect on their own literacy journey, comparing it with the experiences of a community member, while also considering literacy's broader societal implications, fostering growth and critical thinking through reflection.

Joy-Oriented Literacy Pursuit (10 points) :

Students will create and share a literacy-based project that embodies joy, love, and aesthetic fulfillment. Inspired by personal interests, the literacy pursuit will promote liberation, self-determination, and empowerment while being shared with an authentic audience. Students will then reflect on the creation process, their experience of joy and fulfillment, and the connection between their project and course concepts. The assignment encourages creativity and critical engagement with literacy as a tool for social change and future teaching practice

Literacy as Power: Bridging Social Justice and Critical Communication(10 points) :

<https://docs.google.com/document/d/1DzqmpxYOtoKNahVH1d2udTxmrHFp5yPudlJsPwrtq6I/edit>

In this assignment, students will explore the intersection of literacy and social justice by critically analyzing how literacy influences the communication of a chosen social justice issue. Through research, case study analysis (**campaign, article, or initiative**), and reflection, students will assess the accessibility of language used in public discourse, propose strategies to improve communication across literacy levels, and reflect on the importance of literacy in empowering communities. This project encourages students to engage deeply with the concept of critical literacy as a tool for social change, drawing from their own experiences and observations.

Culturally-Historically Responsive Literacy Mini-Unit (30 points):

(https://docs.google.com/document/d/1kPxvalQYBkiMZvV31LIKT_Gs32O17P7n7CVoTtV1HKY/edit?usp=sharing).

This culminating assignment asks students to design a mini-unit that integrates the insights gained throughout the course. Using Gholdy Muhammad's four pursuits—identity, skills, intellect, and criticality—along with the pursuit of joy, students will create culturally and historically responsive literacy lessons. The assignment requires students to apply course concepts by designing lesson plans, creating a sample student assignment, and reflecting on their learning. This project serves as a final assessment of their ability to engage students in meaningful, equity-aligned literacy practices, making it a comprehensive demonstration of the knowledge and skills developed during the course.